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SOUNDCLOUD, A LEADING MUSIC STREAMING SERVICE

M&C Saatchi Performance has partnered with SoundCloud, a leading music and audio streaming platform with a community of artists and musicians constantly uploading new music.

SoundCloud offers both free and paid subscription services to customers. Artists such as Billie Eilish, Post Malone, Khalid and Lorde use SoundCloud services to launch music and grow their followers.

Together we've deployed and optimized a programmatic strategy to increase listenership globally with an emphasis on mobile growth. M&CSP also provides creative services for SoundCloud, enabling testing on different media channels to understand which creative performs most effectively.

APPROACH

UNDERSTAND THE INDUSTRY

Revenues from music streaming in the US grew 26% in H1 2021, accounting for 84% of total music industry revenues in the first half of this year. Spotify, Pandora, SoundCloud and YouTube Music are among the top downloaded music streaming apps in the US in 2021.

UNDERSTAND THE AUDIENCE

By researching the media consumption and motivations of music streamers this inspired our targeting, creative strategy, and media mix. Programmatic marketing provided SoundCloud with the opportunity to leverage 1st party data and emphasize audience discovery.

SoundCloud was able to deploy an audience testing strategy focused on uncovering adjacent interests and affinity segments that correlate with Global Web Index audience trends and motivations.

TAILOR THE MEDIA STRATEGY

Media mix: There are a vast number of Demand-side platforms (DSP) which SoundCloud could leverage, we chose two to work with Smadex & Dv360 based on:

- Strong mobile inventory
- Access to 1st party data
- Strong measurement capabilities

We help SoundCloud navigate changing privacy regulations such as App Tracking Transparency (ATT) by Apple in the Spring of 2021 leveraging relationships with AdTech partners and experience with SKAD network setup.

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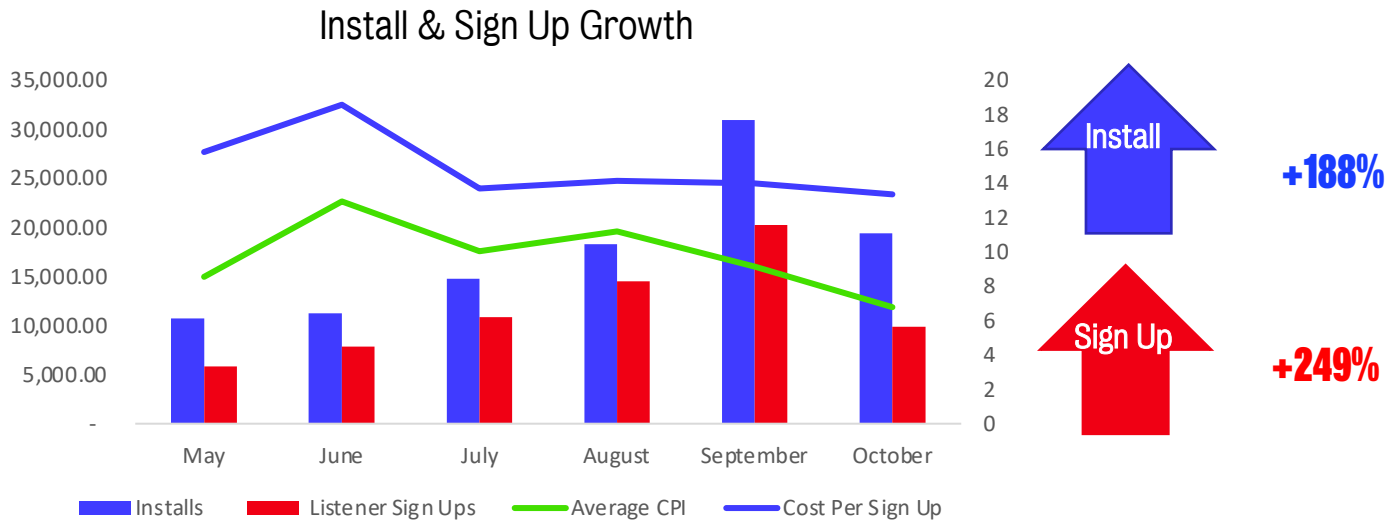
TESTING NEW AUDIENCES TO DRIVE SCALE

Execution: In September we tested 6 new audiences from Dv360 such as College, Fitness, Electronic Natives, Foodies, Lifestyle and Fashion concurrently alongside the tried-and-true audiences such as Music Lovers and Gamers.

Goal: Understand maximum scale if efficiency goals are more lenient. Fold in test audience into long term evergreen campaigns after 6 weeks of testing.



Methodology: Select pre-built affinity and in-market segments that align with GWI research and have scalability based on size. Focus on segments that hit younger demos. Allow the algorithmic buying model to optimize towards highest converting segments while pausing out poor performers

Learnings: Fitness, College, and Electronic targeting drove an increase in over 2K installs while also showing positive improvement in efficiency over time indicating potential to be as efficient as the tried-and-true Music Lovers and Gamers targeting

Results May to Oct 2021

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THE POWER OF PERFORMANCE

105.3K
APP INSTALLS

69K
NEW SIGN UPS

+6
GLOBAL MARKETS

+5
NEW CHANNELS

As a result of strong programmatic performance and diligent audience testing the M&CSP scope of work has expanded to include new channels such as Apple Search, Google, and Social Media

With initial results across Dv360 and Smadex driving scale of 105.3K installs and 69K sign ups in the US market alone; the partnership has now expanded to global user acquisition campaigns based on markets with strong organic listenership or intersection of low competition and large scale

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TALK TO US

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